PHISHING DETECTION & AWARENESS REPORT

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Email Type: Financial Scam / Impersonation Phishing

Risk Level: High

Purpose: To analyze a phishing email, identify indicators of compromise, classify risk and provide user awareness and prevention guidelines.

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1. Executive Summary

This report analyzes a suspicious email claiming to originate from a diplomatic agent representing the International Monetary Fund (IMF). The sender alleges possession of a consignment containing USD 10.5 million and requests the recipient's personal contact information for delivery.

A detailed examination of the email headers, authentication results and message content confirms that the email is malicious. The message exhibits multiple phishing indicators, including domain spoofing, failed authentication checks (SPF, DKIM and DMARC), suspicious sending infrastructure, and social engineering tactics designed to pressure the recipient into disclosing sensitive personal information.

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2. Email Overview

Field	**Value**
From	nemani.tukunia@postfiji.com.fj
Reply-To	mywoodforestbiz.7@gmail.com
Subject	*Attention: I am Diplomatic agent Mr. Wood Forest*
Claimed Organization	International Monetary Fund (IMF)
Requested Action	Reconfirm home address and phone number
Promised Reward	USD 10.5 million

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3. Header Analysis

3.1 Sender Authentication Results

Indicator	Evidence	Interpretation
SPF Failure	Sending IP not authorized by domain	Domain spoofing
DKIM Missing	Message not digitally signed	Lack of message authenticity
DMARC Missing	No enforcement policy	Increased spoofing risk
Suspicious IP Address	109.202.24.52	Untrusted mail source
Mismatched Reply-To	Gmail used instead of official domain	Fraud indicator

Impact:
The failure of all major email authentication mechanisms strongly indicates **email spoofing** and a lack of sender legitimacy.

3.2 Sending Infrastructure Analysis

- Sending IP: **109.202.24.52**
- Intermediate host: **54upr.rosreestr.ru**
- Additional IP observed: **85.208.139.60**

Observations:

- The .ru domain suggests infrastructure unrelated to Fiji, IMF, or any diplomatic organization.
- Geographic and organizational mismatch is a strong phishing indicator.

3.3 Email Routing

The email passed through multiple Microsoft Outlook protection servers; however, this does **not** validate the sender. Microsoft Exchange classified the email with:

- **Spam Confidence Level (SCL): 5**
- **Bulk Complaint Level (BCL): 9**

This indicates the message was identified as likely spam/phishing.

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4. Content Analysis

4.1 Social Engineering Techniques Identified

Technique	Evidence
Authority Impersonation	Claims to be a “Diplomatic Agent” and “IMF Agent”
Urgency	“I am at the airport right now” / “Please hurry up”
Financial Lure	Promise of USD 10.5 million
Information Harvesting	Requests address and phone number

4.2 Content Red Flags

- Poor grammar and inconsistent capitalization
- Vague details about the consignment and delivery
- Mismatch between “From” address and “Reply-To” address
- Use of a generic Gmail account for replies

Legitimate diplomatic or financial institutions do not conduct sensitive transactions via unsolicited emails or Gmail accounts.

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5. Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

Type	Value
Sending IP	109.202.24.52
Sending Domain	54upr.rosreestr.ru
Spoofed Domain	postfiji.com.fj
Reply-To Email	mywoodforestbiz.7@gmail.com

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6. Threat Classification

- **Attack Type:** Phishing (Advance-Fee / Financial Scam)
- **MITRE ATT&CK Technique:**
  - T1566.001 – Phishing: Spear phishing via Email
- **Primary Objective:**
  - Harvest personal information
  - Initiate financial fraud or identity theft

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7. Risk Assessment

Risk Area	Level	Justification
Personal Data Exposure	High	Requests sensitive personal information
Financial Risk	High	Potential for advance-fee fraud
Likelihood of Success	High	Uses authority and urgency tactics
Overall Risk Rating	High	Multiple confirmed phishing indicators

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8. Recommended Actions

1. Do not reply to the email.
2. Do not provide any personal or financial information.
3. Report the email as phishing to the email service provider.
4. Delete the message from the mailbox.
5. Conduct user awareness training on phishing detection.

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9. Prevention & Awareness Guidelines

9.1 For Email Users

- Do not trust unsolicited emails promising large sums of money.
- Verify sender email domains carefully.
- Be suspicious of urgent requests for personal information.
- Avoid replying to emails that redirect communication to free email providers.
- Report suspected phishing emails immediately.

9.2 For Organizations

- Enforce SPF, DKIM, and DMARC policies.
- Conduct regular phishing awareness training.
- Deploy email filtering and threat detection tools.
- Encourage a "report, don't respond" culture among staff.
- Monitor and block known malicious IP addresses.

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10. Conclusion

This email is a **confirmed phishing attempt** that employs spoofed sender information, failed email authentication mechanisms, and persuasive social engineering tactics to deceive the recipient. The message poses a **high risk** and should be treated as malicious. Proper reporting and user awareness are essential to prevent exploitation.